

Alex Zaalishvili

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SUMMARY

Software engineer, B.S. Computer Science December 2026. Shipped a commercial game on Steam (1,000+ sales) and a production web app that a tutoring studio runs on daily; lead engineer on a 55k-line Unity codebase. C# and TypeScript daily, Rust and C++ as needed. Comfortable owning a feature from requirements to deploy.

SKILLS

Languages: C#, TypeScript/JavaScript, C++, Rust, Python, SQL

Web & Backend: React, Next.js, Node.js, REST APIs, Prisma, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Auth.js, Stripe

Tools & Practices: Git/GitHub, GitHub Actions, Vercel, Linux, unit testing, code review, technical documentation

Game Engines: Unity, MonoGame, Unreal (C++), Godot, SpacetimeDB, Steamworks SDK

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Developer | Siphon Games, Brooklyn, NY (remote team)

Apr 2023 – Present

- Designed, built, and shipped Banana Clicker (Unity/C#) on Steam, Mar 2023: 1,000+ unique sales, 10+ post-launch patches from player feedback. ~23k lines of C#: service layer with explicit lifecycles, typed event bus, Addressables-loaded content, multi-slot saves, Steam achievements (github.com/AbsoluteSG/banana-clicker-source).
- Lead engineering on No Dogs Allowed, a 2D Metroidvania in Unity 6: ~55k lines of C# across nine assembly definitions with a one-directional dependency graph; data-driven items, recipes, crops, and quests; in-editor content tools so artists and designers author without code.
- Run the Git workflow, documentation, and release schedule for a distributed team of contract artists and composers; built the studio site and a story-authoring tool in Next.js/TypeScript.

Help Desk Assistant | CUNY College of Staten Island, Staten Island, NY

Jul 2022 – Dec 2023

- Front-line technical support for students, faculty, and staff: hardware, software, network, and account issues, in person, by phone, and through the campus ticketing system; triaged and documented tickets and kept the knowledge base current.

PROJECTS

Borough Prep — Tutor Payroll — Next.js 16, TypeScript, Prisma, PostgreSQL, Auth.js, Stripe Connect [live](#) · [code](#)

- Marketing site + full-stack bookkeeping app for Borough Prep, an independent tutoring studio; replaced their shared spreadsheet and is in production with real tutors and a manager role.
- Role-based auth with invite links, an append-only ledger (rates snapshotted per class so history never rewrites), one-click Stripe Connect payouts, and a live-chat queue with staff presence heartbeat plus a rate-limited AI assistant.

Vision Bots — game agents from screen capture — Python, YOLOv8, OpenCV, Gymnasium, Stable-Baselines3 [write-up](#)

- Fine-tuned two YOLOv8 detectors on 340 hand-labelled frames (AP@0.5 0.94 on the player class); built a landmark-graph navigator with belief state and recovery behaviours, and a PPO agent driving a second game through a Gymnasium env at 15 Hz. No game API: Win32 capture in, synthetic input out.

Critter Cove — co-op zoo builder — Rust, Macroquad, SpacetimeDB, Steamworks [code](#)

- ~30k lines of Rust across three crates with 200+ tests on the engine-free domain: chunk streaming with hysteresis, noise-driven biomes with weighted spawn tables, 100+ species with hybrid recipes, versioned saves with forward migrations, a Steam relay transport, and a SpacetimeDB online hub.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science | CUNY College of Staten Island

Expected Dec 2026

Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Object-Oriented Programming, Operating Systems, Database Systems, High-Performance Computing, Calculus I–III, Linear Algebra